

HURRICANE PASS

★ 4.7/5 (77 reviews) Silverton, [Colorado](#) (San Juan County) Last Updated: 10/15/2024

Difficulty - Mandatory
3 - MODERATE

Difficulty - Optional
3 - MODERATE

Reported as of 06/01/2026
Partially Open

Distance
2.24 mi

Duration (one-way)
About 30 minutes

Highest Elevation	Shape of Trail	Typically Open	Best Direction	Official Trail Name	Nearest Town	Nearest Services
12729 ft	Connector	07/01 - 11/01	N/A	San Juan County Road 10	Silverton	Silverton

Management Agency
San Juan County, Colorado

TRAIL EXPERIENCE

 **Altitude**  **Beginner**  **Ghost Town**  **Iconic**  **Mine**  **Overland**  **Scenic**

Hurricane Pass is a unique trail in the San Juan Mountains above the timberline. High alpine animals are frequently spotted, bringing another feature to attract users to this beautiful area. Climbing steeply up the mountain between Hurricane Peak and Brown Mountain, this mildly technical yet intriguing trail is a common addition to form one of the many takes on the Alpine Loop. Combine this trail with [County Road 2](#), [California Pass](#), and either [Corkscrew Pass](#) or [County Road 10](#) to create an epic day-long adventure.

Recommended Vehicle:
Stock SUV with High Clearance and 4 Low

Concerns:

✓ None	✓ No Full Size	✓ Body Damage
✓ Width	✓ Height	✓ Short Wheelbase Only
✓ Narrow Shelf Road	✓ Mild Off Camber	✓ Moderate Off Camber
✓ Extreme Off Camber	✓ Impassable When Wet	✓ Deep Sand
✓ Mud	✓ Pinstriping	✓ High Water Crossings

Summary:
The small obstacle at Waypoint 2 defines the trail's rating.

Mandatory	3 - MODERATE	Optional	3 - MODERATE
The hardest part of the trail that you cannot bypass - you have to drive it.		The hardest part of the trail that is purely optional - you can bypass it.	

TRAIL NAVIGATION

Hurricane Pass is an easy shelf road trail in the San Juan Mountains of SW Colorado. It begins off of [Corkscrew Pass](#) and connects to [California Pass](#) and [Poughkeepsie Gulch](#). The 2.25-mile trail is primarily packed dirt and occasional rocky patches. The trail climbs 1,200 feet steadily over the first 1.7 miles, so a low-range transfer case is highly recommended.

1. Western Trailhead (0 mi) 



The western trailhead is situated at the end of [Corkscrew Pass](#). The initial climb from the trailhead is a shelf road, but visibility is excellent, allowing ample time to see and prepare for oncoming traffic. The historic Mogul Mine can be seen across the valley at this point.

2. Small Obstacle (0.84 mi)



There are not very many obstacles on Hurricane Pass, but this is an example of what one may look like.

3. Ore Shoot (1.02 mi)



An ore chute is found adjacent to the trail. The chute still contains gold ore, showing how quickly the mines in this area ceased operating, and the workers seemed to have just walked away.

4. Dead-End Spur (1.14 mi)



Continue heading north. Signs state this is a dead-end spur.

5. Approach to Summit (1.32 mi)



Closer to the summit, the trail gets a little steeper. Be sure to utilize your low-range transfer case to help reduce stress on your drivetrain.

6. Alaska Basin (1.58 mi)



Alaska Basin veers off to the north while Hurricane Pass continues east.

7. Final Climb/Pass (1.67 mi)



The trail reaches Hurricane Pass Summit. Beautiful blue Lake Como is visible to the northeast. Please remember the weather in this area can change rapidly, so be prepared for inclement weather.

8. Shelf Road (1.94 mi)



The descent to Lake Como is a narrow shelf road, about 1.5 vehicles wide. There is good visibility to see oncoming traffic, so proceed once it is clear. Please remember, uphill has the right of way. There are several wider spots where vehicles can pass if the situation arises.

9. Eastern Trailhead (2.23 mi)



The trail comes to an end at a 3-way intersection near Lake Como. Turning uphill to the east follows the popular [California Pass](#) trail into the ghost town of Animas Forks. Turning north leads drivers down the difficult [Poughkeepsie Gulch](#).

✓ Not Allowed

No dispersed camping is available on Hurricane Pass. The connected trail Corkscrew Pass offers many free dispersed camping options near its trailhead, 4.8 miles west at Ironton Park. This camping area is well suited to small travel trailers or RV's. A much more secluded camping area is located 1.5 miles up Corkscrew Pass.